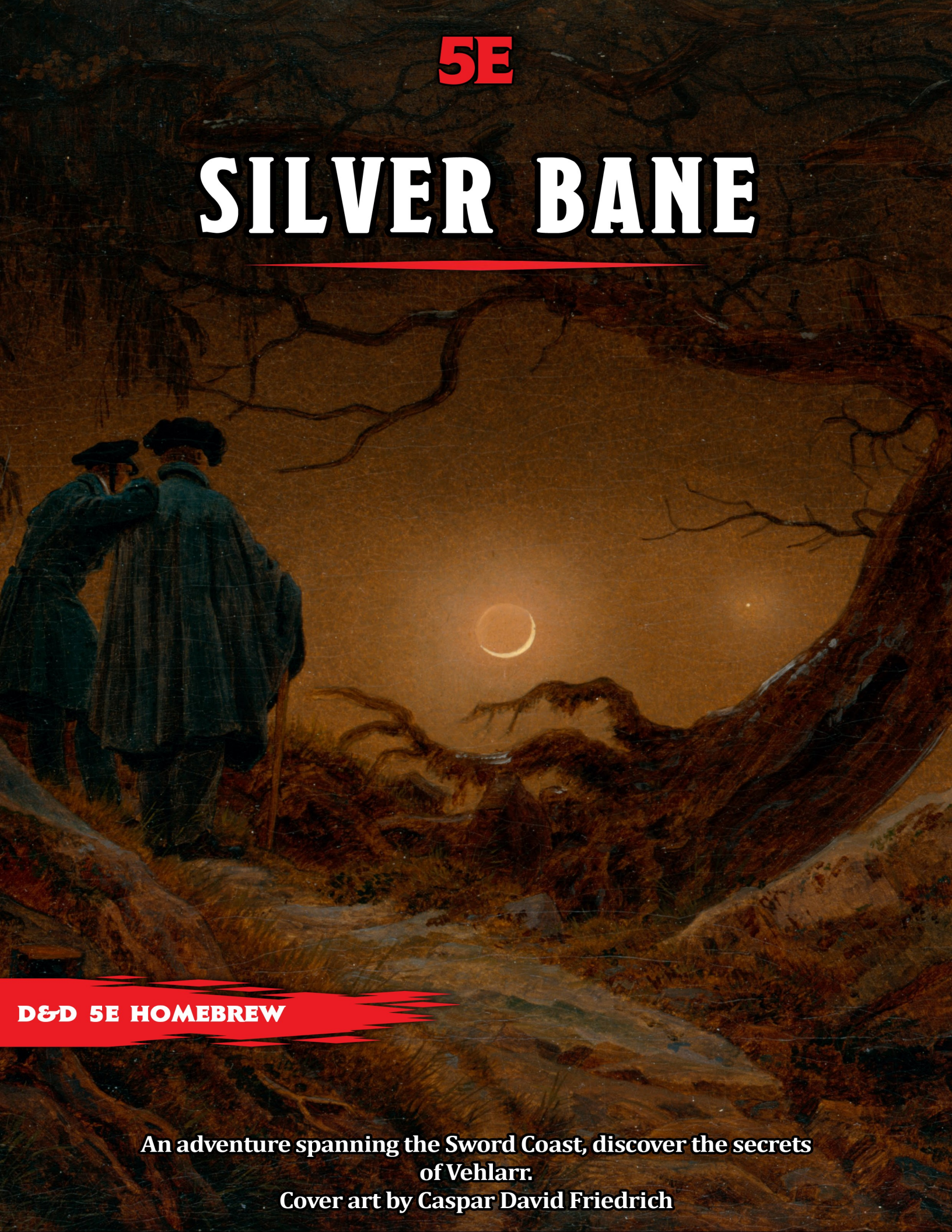
5E

SILVER BANE



D&D 5E HOMEBREW

An adventure spanning the Sword Coast, discover the secrets of Vehlarr.

Cover art by Caspar David Friedrich

The Silver Bane Campaign

The Amphail Affair

Introduction: Seeking a rest from travel, the Party arrives in Amphail, looking forward to a warm meal and a refreshing drink. The villagers gather as the night falls and a friendly, peaceful night begins. The calm of the evening is soon shattered as a woman rushes into the tavern, screaming hysterically.

A 2-hour adventure intended for 1st-3rd level characters

by Callum Williamson



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Introduction

This encounter is intended to be the introductory session of a homebrew campaign beginning in Amphail and contains references to homebrew rules for that campaign, which are included in the 'Homebrew Rules' section.

It can be run as a one-shot for any running campaign by placing it in any small village. A lot of information and choices are given here as there is an assumption that a first time or beginner DM will be running the encounter, who may not be as comfortable being 'on-the-fly', there are multiple branching points and opportunities for the DM to bring the Party back to the intended plot but also examples of consequences that you can implement in 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section.

There are multiple options for the DM to sidestep difficult combat with NPC actions to allow this to run with as little as 1 DM and 1 Player.

Running as part of The Silver Bane Campaign

Key things to remember if running as part of the 'Silver Bane':

- The Party should learn about **Lycanthropy**, **Belladonna**, and **Variscite**.
- The Party will almost certainly not be able to kill the lycanthropes when they are at full health and not under the effect of **Belladonna** / **Variscite**. A single attack from a wererat could kill a character with too low of a total health pool in a single hit, especially at level 1.
- The woodsman does not use the wererat stat block when he is in human form, this is because he has never transformed before, but he will transform if his health reaches 0 HP.
- Saving villagers is directly tied to their reward.
- Remember about Passive skills, if a check is equal to or lower than a Characters base stat and modifier, maybe allow them to automatically succeed.
- If anyone drops to 0 HP, and no one was prepared to have their character die in the first session, ensure their body is evacuated by either a fleeing villager or another Party member, this could bring them back into the fold with 1 HP or they just survive for the next session if it happens towards the end. You can even hide and fiddle with the death throws.
- 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section is for a Party that is just not engaging with the session, blundering so hard that you need to kill some villagers, or are able to damage the wererats significantly and you want to include a fight.

The Party Arrive

Text within boxes like below is meant to be read out loud, dice rolls and other important information will be **bold**.

Each member of the party has come to Amphail to rest after long journeys, congregating one by one in the Amphail Ale, they sit at a shared table.



Tavern Scene by Joos van Craesbeeck

The atmosphere in the tavern is welcoming, the fire warm, the food and drink refreshing after your journey. It is a peaceful evening, the local shopkeepers and villagers begin to congregate in the tavern as the day comes to a close, soon the whole town is gathered, 18 people crowd the tavern as a lively night begins.

Take this opportunity to have the Party introduce their characters, perhaps they speak to the villagers.

Investigate disturbances on the road leading between Amphail and Waterdeep. Someone mentions that they have been waiting for a letter for some time, and another says it has been a few days since any merchants travelled through town.

The foresters have been finishing work early, so they are home long before nightfall.

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Intelligence (Investigation) DC 12 / Wisdom (Perception DC 12) / Wisdom (Insight) DC 12 *– The Character notices a woman fussing over a woodsman's bandage in the corner, he is trying to rest. When asked about it he will say it was just from an accident with an axe but the woman won't believe him.*



The Wounded Man by Gustave Courbet

If pressed to see the wound, ***Charisma (Persuasion / Intimidation) DC 12*** *the party can try to examine it.*

Wisdom (Nature) DC 12*, they can observe the wound is actually a bite mark, they are unable to tell which animal caused it, but they can tell it has a large mouth from the puncture pattern.*

Intelligence (Medicine) DC 12*, they can tell the wound is infected and that it likely from an animal attack.*

In truth it doesn't matter what the Party decides to do at this point, before they can do anything further a villager bursts into the tavern screaming.

The welcoming and relaxing atmosphere slowly dies as muffled screams come from outside.

Suddenly the door to the Amphail Ale slams open as a woman bursts into the tavern screaming in terror.

"It's here! oh gods! the monster is here! It killed Delvin!" The woman cries, collapsing to the ground as she enters the safety of the tavern.

"Valiria? What in the hells are you talking about?" another villager asks, as they rush over to her, urging her to sit down at a table.

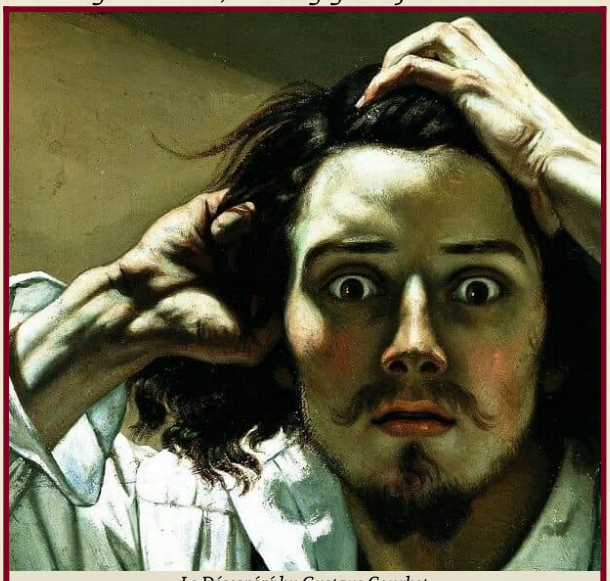


Woman, Why Weepest Thou? by Fritz von Uhde

The Party watch as the other villagers immediately split into two groups, some heading outside to investigate and the others crowding round the woman, a majority stay.

At this point the Party will decide what they will do, will they stay and hear what Valiria has to say or will they go outside to investigate?

If the party interacted with the woodsman, they look around at the scene before them and notice he is even more on edge, he hasn't moved from his chair and he is staring at Valiria, seemingly terrified.



Le Désespéré by Gustave Courbet

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Staying in the tavern

The Party has decided to stay in the tavern, or have returned after being outside and you decided to allow them to return with no consequences, and speak with the occupants.

The Party approaches the table where Valiria is sitting and hear the following:
"Slow down Valiria, breathe, tell us what happened" the bartender says, trying to soothe her.

"He... He's dead... I... There was so much blood" Valiria sobs into her hands.

The Party realises she is nearly inconsolable in her current state.

The Party may try to speak to Valiria, the woodsman, or head outside at this point. **7 villagers leave** the tavern to investigate and **11 villagers stay**, including the barman, the woodsman, and Valiria.

Speaking to Valiria

Valiria is sitting at a table surrounded by the remaining villagers.

Wisdom (Insight) DC 10 *– The Party successfully sees that Valiria is terrified to her core, there won't be an easy way to calm her down without a good deal of convincing or a shock to her senses. (Meant to gently nudge the players towards a solution)*

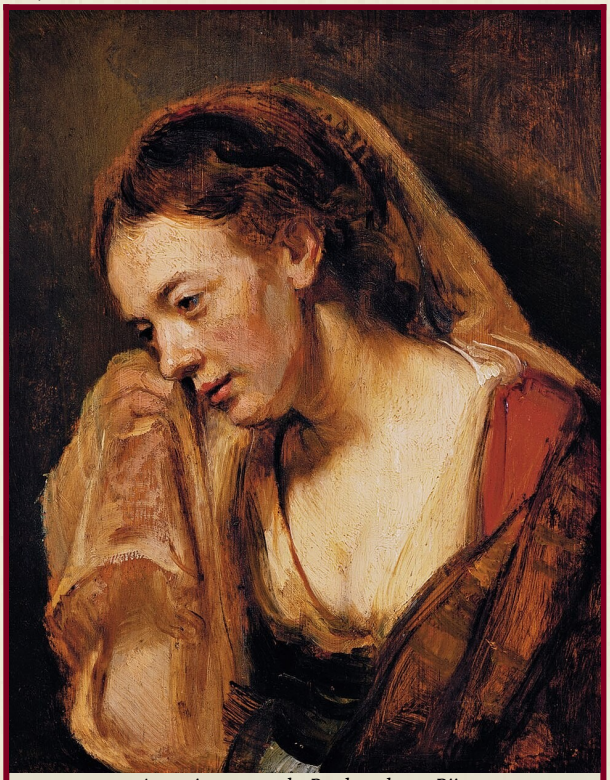
Charisma (Persuasion) DC 12 or Charisma (Intimidation) DC 15 *– The Party successfully manages to calm her down. After some shuddering breathes Valiria explains what happened, "My husband Delvin... I went outside to fetch him for supper and... all I found were his clothes, ripped to shreds on the ground, great chunks of his skin... everywhere..."*

*If pressed for details, all she will add is "I told them I wasn't lying... I told them I saw it... now he's dead...", she begins sobbing again at this point and will not elaborate unless **Calm Person** is cast on her or the Party get her a **drink** (does not have to be a strong drink).*

*If **Calm Person** is cast or she is given a **drink**, she settles down and says "It was the monster in the forest, I don't know what it was but I saw it when I was foraging for **belladonna** last month. I tried to tell the others but they just ignored me and said I was spooked by a boar."*

*Characters **proficient in Nature** are told that **belladonna** is a poisonous plant that can hurt them if handled incorrectly, by making an **Intelligence (Nature) DC 10** ability check. It's used to make an a numbing salve. They note that her fingers and hands have hives on them, a reaction to touching the plant.*

If the Party asks why the creature didn't attack her, she doesn't know.



A weeping woman by Rembrandt van Rijn

Wisdom (Medicine) DC 10 *– The Party inspects Valiria for injuries. There are no injuries on Valeria, the blood she is covered in is presumably from Delvin. The blood is on her face, hands, and chest.*

Physical Strike *– The Party decides to physically shock Valiria.*

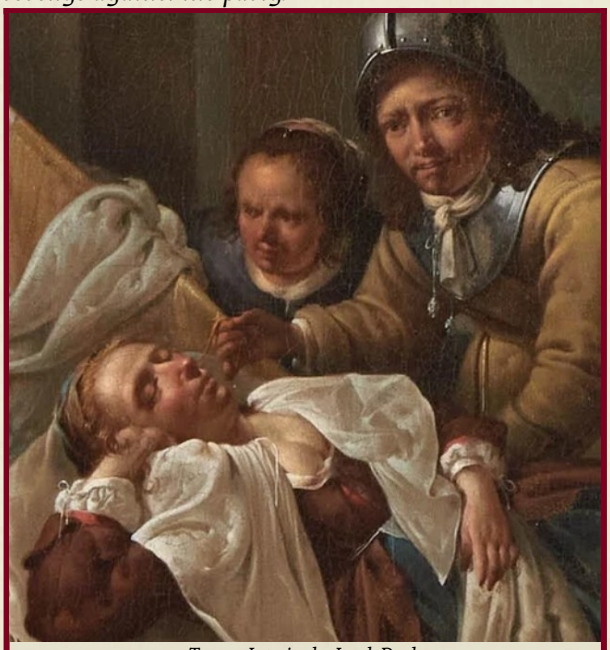
Slap – Strength DC 14*, a Character slaps Valiria to shock her into calmness.*

*On a **normal failure**, she recoils and cries harder, she is inconsolable now, the barkeep strongly suggests that the Party leave her alone, he will not be persuaded to let them speak to her, nor would she speak to the Party if they were somehow able to get to her.*

*On a **critical fail**, or just if you think it will be **entertaining**, the slap knocks her out, the villagers around rush to her and chastise the Party, ordering them to leave the tavern, leading them to the scene were Greela is just about to see the monster. This can have a small effect for the 'The Transformation' section*

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if you decide to have her get a small amount of revenge against the party.



Tavern Interior by Jacob Duck

***Shake – Strength DC 8**, a Character gently shakes Valiria. Has the same effect as the 'pressed for details' paragraph for the Charisma check above and no negatives if they fail, but you could consider having the failure react the same way as the normal failure for slapping her above.*

***Get her a drink** – The Party suggest she have a **drink** to calm her nerves, which has the same effect as the first paragraph for the Charisma check above.*

*If pressed, she will accept another **drink** but asks for something stronger, this has a similar effect to if **Calm Person** was cast on her. The barman offers her a swig of his homemade **moonshine**, it's an incredibly strong high alcohol content **drink**, the smell alone nearly burns your nostrils.*

*Characters **proficient in Alchemy Supplies**, or those with an **Intelligence score of 15 or higher**, realise that this is an incredibly **flammable** and potentially unstable liquid. The barman's **moonshine** is nearly 80% alcohol.*

*If offered another **drink**, she will decline saying she is feeling unwell after the last one, but if the Party push her it will render her **Unconscious** as she faints from the combination of the alcohol and shock. This will have a small effect the 'The Transformation' section.*

Speaking to the Woodsman

If the party spoke to woodsman before, they are now able to insist he explains his injury as they notice how nervous he now is that Valiria is here, and he is sitting alone in the corner.

***Charisma (Persuasion / Intimidation) DC 15** – If the party already discovered that the wound is a bite mark they have **Advantage** on this roll. The Party convinces the woodsman to detail what happened to him.*

The woodsman whispers, "Fine I'll tell you, but keep your voices down... Last night I was coming home, I hadn't paid any mind to the stories people round here were spreading, but then I saw it... something in the corner of my eye, watching me... I could see it creeping between the trees, something as big as I am, hairy too, and a disgusting, fleshy tail... Anyway I start sprinting and chomp!... I dig my fingers into it's eyes before I could even think, the beast let go of me and I ran as fast as I could... The thing didn't chase after me... I thought that would be the end of it... I should have told someone..."



Once it Chased Dr. Wilkerson Into the Very Town Itself by Howard Pyle

If the Party has not already inspected the wound, the woodsman lets them examine it. They do not need to roll anything here as he tells them that the wound is infected.

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Physically Threaten *– The Party physically threatens the woodsman to reveal what happened to him. As he is injured and scared, the Party will automatically succeed at this.*

The woodsman begs the Party not to hurt him. This draws some villagers away from Valiria. "Okay, Okay, I'll tell you" The rest is the same as persuading him except he now also apologises to the villagers and Valiria directly, "I'm sorry I didn't believe you Valiria, I'm so sorry..."

Valiria just nods solemnly in response.

The Party might be convinced to keep an eye on the woodsman or restrain him, if the want to do this allow it, but have them roll the following.

Charisma (Persuasion) DC 16*, with* ***Advantage*** *if they uncovered his story AND the possible connection to* ***Lycanthropy*** *– You successfully convince the villagers that it would be a good idea to restrain the woodsman as you think he is infected.*

If the result is ***18 or higher****, the woodsman allows you to do this. Otherwise, roll a* ***Strength (Athletics) DC 16*** *to forcefully do so.*

The villagers will react with disdain toward the Party if they forcefully retrain the woodsman as they failed to convince them it was necessary, possibly making them leave the tavern.

Speaking to the villagers

Should the Party decide to speak to other patrons of the bar, before speaking to Valiria, then no one has any idea what is going on as they are also trying to find out what is happening, they will shoo the Party as they try to eavesdrop or speak to Valiria themselves, some example statements are shown below.

"Shh! I can't hear what she's saying."

"Did you see how much blood is on her?"

"Hells, I can't fathom what would do this."

"Poor Valiria, she looks scared to death."

If the Party only managed to get the basic information from Valiria, the other patrons will be shocked and sympathetic towards Valeria.

"Oh gods, Delvin is dead!"

"What could have done this?"

"To shreds she said."

If the Party managed to get Valiria to talk about the monster, the other patrons will shuffle around nervously with guilty expressions.

"She came running into the village shouting about some hairy beast she saw, we thought she was just spooked, had we have known..."

"I'm so sorry Valiria, we... we should have believed you..."

"We didn't listen and now... oh poor Delvin..."

"I mean people told stories... but to think they are real... it's terrifying."

None of the villagers are aware of the woodsman's injury and will offer next to no details.

"Oh that sort of thing happens all the time... between the wolves, boars, and whatever else lives in there, someone always comes home with a scratch or two"

"I don't know why he'd lie about it being an axe wound... excuse me I need to see if Valiria is okay"

If the Party got Valiria to reveal about the monster*, "Surely it wasn't from the same beast? Why would he hide it?"*

They do not leave

If the Party spends too much time in the tavern, by either exhausting their talking points with Valiria and the woodsman, and speaking with too many villagers, or by lingering to see what happens (roughly 5 to 10 minutes of in game time), or just doesn't go outside, then the plot advances.

The door slams open again and the villagers who left earlier return, though dishevelled, exhausted and terrified.

"It was there! It was outside!" a villager shouts, "Just at the edge of the village, standing and staring at us!"

"Greela went over to scare it away and it mauled his arms and bit his neck! The poor whoreson was dead in an instant" another villager adds.

"Elimar threw a pitchfork at it and flew into the beasts chest, but it pulled it out and threw it to the ground... the thing scurried away but it didn't seem injured." a third villager continues.

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"It was the size of a man and as hairy as a wolf, with a twisted, fleshy tail" Elimar confirms.

*The villagers are panicking now, being non-combatants, everyone is **Frightened** of the monster. They are refusing to go outside again and are at a loss about what to do, some suggest locking the doors and windows and hiding, some others suggest fleeing the village entirely.*

*The Party can attempt to rally the villagers with a **Charisma (Persuasion) DC14** ability roll, which removes the '**Can't Approach**' effect of Frightened. If they roll a **DC18 or higher**, the Frightened effect is totally removed and the DM could award the Character that gives the speech the 'Amphail Alliance' **Heroic Inspiration** point.*

The Party might suggest leaving the tavern to investigate, if this happens proceed to the 'Leave the Tavern' section, and allow them to make the checks found at the start of that section other than the Perception check to see the creature as it has already gone.

"Be careful out there, come back and tell us if you find anything, the monster ran into the woods but keep watch and be safe." one of the villagers that was outside says to the Party.

If the Party returns from their investigation, stays in the tavern, or decides to flee, move onto 'The Woodsman Turns' section. This could be a branching point for 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section.

Tavern Loot

Should the Party try to pickpocket anyone that isn't Valiria:

Some amount of coins (2d4 sp, 3d6 cp).
AND one of;
Their (dirty, clean, lacy) handkerchief.
The key to their home.
A button and some lint.
Pocket cheese, a small coin sized chunk of cheese, has hair on it.
A small knife, the handle is made of horn.
A silver earscoop, there are wax remnants still on it.
A wooden pipe.

Should the Party try to pickpocket or loot Valiria at any point:

Some amount of coins (2d4 sp, 3d6 cp).
OR
A 1d4 amount of Belladonna, the Character takes 1d2 Poison damage per Belladonna sprig.
You feel a dull throbbing pain in your hand as your fingers wrap around the sprigs of Belladonna tucked into Valirias apron, she catches you in the act.

Should the Party try to steal from the bar:

Some amount of coins in the till (3d10 sp, 4d10 cp).
A 13 gallon barrel of homemade moonshine, it weighs over 80lbs.
A jar of pickled eggs.
A pork pie.
An unopened litre bottle of mead.
Tall Tales to Tell Tykes – The folklore story book that the barman will try to use to explain the monster is a wererat.
Should the Character read the book, the Character will gain advantage on all checks to identify the creature and will automatically know it is a wererat when first encountered.
It does not offer any great detail other than children's stories about monsters in the night.

Should the Party try to steal from the back office:

Some amount of coins (0-1gp, 3d20 sp, 4d20 cp).
Ink, quills, parchment.
The barman's recipe for making moonshine.

Should the Party try to steal from the storeroom:

Same food items as the Bar as well as the 'Food, Drink, and Lodging' table.
Large Barrels of ale.
Food related items on the 'Trade Goods' table.

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Leaving the Tavern

The Party follows the other villagers outside, if the Party leave the group at any point and do not return to the villagers outside or the tavern then this could be a branching point for 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section.

The Party exits the tavern with a group of villagers, as they scan the area they see nothing. The villagers quickly light torches and grab various farm tools to defend themselves.

"Follow me, I know where Valiria lives as she is my neighbour." a dwarf named Greela says.
The group follows Greela to Valirias home, a hovel on the edge of the village, the group find the torn clothes and chunks of flesh that Valiria spoke of. The grizzly scene makes the villagers scared, some vomit at the sight.

***Intelligence (Medicine) DC 12** – The Character notices that there are no organs or bones amongst the carnage, just chunks of skin and blood.*

*Characters that are **proficient in Medicine** will be able to discern that it is an entire bodies worth of skin.*

***Wisdom (Survival) DC 12** – The Character notices the monster tracks leading away from the scene, but none leading to it. The tracks lead away from the village, they are unable to identify what creature made them.*

*Characters that are **proficient in Survival** will be able to discern that the Delvins footprints begin to falter in the lead up to the gruesome scene, the tracks look almost like those of a giant rat.*

***Intelligence (Investigation) DC 16** – The Character gains the information of the passive checks above, but not the detail in the proficiencies.*

***Wisdom (Perception) DC 16** – The Character notices the monster in the distance themself and lets the Party know they can see a man sized creature silhouetted in the distance.*

*If the Character has **Darkvision**, they can confirm that it is a humanoid, with rat-like features.*

***Intelligence (Arcana) DC 14** – The Character is able to to recall information about creatures such as these, it appears to be some sort of **lycanthrope**, incredibly dangerous as they they have **Advantage** against all but **Silvered or magical attacks**.*

If they don't connect the dots on their own at this point, have them also realise that this could be Delvin, and the chunks of flesh were from his transformation. Also explains any investigations they carried out, such as the lack of tracks before the pile of flesh.

Should the Party fail to pass any of the above checks, or simply take a while, Greela begins to disturb the scene, poking and prodding the mass of flesh and mumbling to himself. Should the Party try to stop him, Greela simply waves them off saying he's "seen bigger beasts than this.

Greela begins mumbling to himself, prodding the masses of flesh.

"What a mess... What in the Hells happened here... How do you even clean up something like this..."

The other villagers sort of mill about, not really wanting to look at the body, Greela spots the monster himself.

"It's there!" he shouts, pointing towards the road. The group looks over to what he is pointing at and see it, a man sized, hairy creature off in the distance.

*Characters with **Darkvision** can see it more clearly, as Greela does, it is a humanoid shaped rat.*

"You there! Away with you!" Greela shouts, marching towards the creature, the group follows behind him and watches as he walks towards it without any fear.

"I said go! Away with you! Shoo!" Greela raises his arm to shoo the creature away and a swift flurry of movement stops him before he can finish his sentence.

The group watch as Greela is lifted off of the ground, his arms are torn from his body as the creature sinks its teeth into his neck, his torch falling to the floor, fully illuminating the creature.

***Intelligence (Arcana) DC 14** – The Character is able to to recall information about creatures such as these, it appears to be some sort of **lycanthrope**, incredibly dangerous as they have **Advantage** against all but **Silvered or magical attacks**.*

If they don't connect the dots on their own at this point, have them also realise that this is Delvin, and the chunks of flesh were from his transformation. Also explains any investigations they carried out, such as the lack of tracks before the pile of flesh.

The Party turn as Elimar, (Greelas wife), screams and throws a pitchfork expertly towards the creature. They watch it bury deep into the creatures abdomen.

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Intelligence (Investigation) DC 14 *– You notice that Elimar is wearing an identical ring to Greela.*

Celebration turns to horror as Elimar watches the creature pluck the pitchfork out of its stomach unfazed and toss it to the ground, shrieking menacingly at the group, before retreating into the night.

The villagers are ***Terrified*** *now, they begin to turn back to the tavern, begging the Party to follow them to safety.*

Should the Party attempt to stop Greela, a fight begins with the creature, move onto 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section.

Should the Party decide to further investigate anything outside, decide **whether** to let them do it and go back to the tavern without repercussions in which case let them re-investigate anything they didn't find the first time with **Advantage** and either advance to 'The Woodsman Turns' section or let them play out the 'Staying in the Tavern' section if they completed this quickly, the villagers let them back in if they were previously asked to leave.

Should the Party want to investigate any of the houses, it's advised that they find Greelas house as he is Valiria neighbour, but when they are done perhaps say they hear shrieks and should maybe head back to the tavern. This could be a branching point for 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section.

If they want to chase after Delvin, it is **strongly suggested** that they either lose the trail or simply cannot find him and return to the tavern. Otherwise this could be a branching point for 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section.

Loot outside

Should the Party try to loot the flesh pile:

There is almost nothing amongst the piles of sinew and skin, in the torn clothing you find:
2d4 sp, 3d6 cp.

Should the Party try to loot Greelas body:

Some amount of coins (1 gp, 2d4 sp, 3d6 cp).
AND
The key to his house.
AND
A polished silver ring with a green gemstone.
Characters ***proficient with Jeweller's Tools*** *can identify the gemstone as Variscite, but are unaware of the specific lycanthrope related properties.*

Should the Party try to loot any of the houses while outside the Character must succeed a **Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) DC 12** using **Thieves Tools** to break into any of the houses (Looting more than one could be a branching point for 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section.

If the house is Greelas and they looted his corpse, they should have a key which would bypass this check. No-one is home in any of the houses as they are all gathered in the Tavern or investigating Delvins 'corpse':

The Party look around the small home and see that it is the home of an average villager, no great treasures or valuables in sight.
Some amount of coins in a drawer (0-1gp, 2d4 sp, 3d6 cp).
Various foodstuffs and water.
Various clothes, none of any worth for trade.
Clay pots.
A chamber pot. Contains a single turd floating in urine if investigated.
Miscellaneous items, use 'Adventuring Gear' list, 10 sp or under.

If you decide the house is Greelas, the Party see a sign next to the side of the door "Greela & Elimars House":
Same item list as above.
Intelligence (Investigation) DC 12 *– You find a small box, it appears to be an old storage box that has the Jewellers Guild seal on it:*
A single set of Jewellers Tools.
A copy of 'Jewels and Gemcutting'.
A few small chunks of green gemstone, likely leftover from making Greela and Elimars rings.

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The Woodsman Turns

At this point the Party should be fairly convinced that they have little hope of fighting whatever the creature is, or if they already fought Delvin they will likely be very wounded.

The barman lifts a cask of moonshine onto the bar.

"Come, have a drink to steel your nerves!" he instructs the villagers and Party who witnessed the attack. You see him struggling to lift a 13 gallon barrel onto the bar, "This is a particularly strong tonic of my own invention"

The Party very quickly learns that this is an incredibly high alcohol content spirit, the smell alone burning the edges of their nostrils.

*Characters **Proficient in Alchemy Supplies**, or those with an **Intelligence score of 15 or higher**, realise that this is an incredibly flammable and potentially unstable liquid. The barman's moonshine is nearly 80% alcohol.*

If they have not already been able to discern that it is a **lycanthrope**, but have passed some of the checks in the previous stages, have them explain what they found to the barman, who happens to be a folklore enjoyer and is begging them to explain what they discovered.

If the Party joined the villagers and witnessed the attack:

"Tell us, what did you discover out there? Is what they are saying true?" the barman grabs the closest party member, desperately pleading for answers.

After the Party tells him:

*"Just a pile of skin left on the ground? No tracks leading to the scene? Unfazed by the terrible wound in it's stomach? Hairy? Rat tail? Human sized?" the barman replies, his face grey, "We have to leave, we need to get out of here now! Everyone! We need to flee! It's a bleeding **wererat**! We cannot even harm it, let alone kill it!"**

If the Party spoke to Valiria and the woodsman:

"What did they say to you? I saw you talking to them" the barman grabs the closest party member, desperately pleading for answers.

After the Party tells him:

*Hairy? Fast? Bites? Human sized? Scared of Belladonna?" the barman replies, his face grey, "We have to leave, we need to get out of here now! Everyone! We need to flee! It's a bleeding **wererat**! We cannot even harm it, let alone kill it!"*

If the Party was unable to gleam any relevant information:

*The Party watch as the barman's face pales to grey as he listens to the group describe the attack. "Unfazed by the terrible wound in it's stomach? Hairy? Rat tail? Human sized? No sign of Delvins body? We have to leave, we need to get out of here now! Everyone! We need to flee! It's a bleeding **wererat**! We cannot even harm it, let alone kill it!"*

The barman also explains to Valiria, and the others, that Delvin isn't dead, he is the monster. He leans down and comforts her as he does, almost apologetically.

At this point he also explains how he could know this information.

If the Party asks how he can be sure, have the barman throw a well read, old book of folklore at them that he pulls from behind the bar, "That's how I know, page 14!"

*The book is not an encyclopaedia, it is somewhat akin to a child's storybook of dangerous monsters, but the story told is remarkably similar to what they just witnessed, a half dozen militiamen torn asunder by a hairy beast without taking more than a scratch. It does not detail in any way how to deal with lycanthropes other than a brief section about **their resilience to attacks that aren't Silvered or magical** as well as an old wives tale about hanging **Belladonna** above the doorway of your home to protect yourself.*

If the Party stole the book:

"It was here, a book, I had a book that explained it all! I swear, I promise we are all in danger!"

The Party can decide to give the book back and admit they took it, in which case he snatches it away and demands they also return anything else they stole from the bar.

The Party could also be the ones to warn the villagers, or agreeing with the barman, convincing them to flee. **6 of the villagers will decide to flee at this point (including Elimar), leaving 11 in the tavern**, but a new threat begins for those that stay.

The fleeing villagers will **survive** as they were able to leave before the woodsman turns and Delvin returns, they will meet up with any survivors in the 'What Next?' section.

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This could be a branching point for 'The Worst Possible Outcome' section, should the Party decide to flee at this point without witnessing the transformation.

The Transformation

Assuming the Party didn't flee, the woodsman reveals himself.

> *As the Party and villagers stand trying to decide what to do, they hear a thick, wet cough and spit. The Party notices the woodsman in the corner, his face pale, sweat beading down his brow. He is rocking slightly in his chair. As you stare at him, the other villagers also begin to notice him, beginning to back away slightly, whispering among themselves.*

At this point you can decide if Valiria wakes up if she was knocked out.

> *Valiria stirs in her chair, she begins to come to, taking in the scene before her, she too stares at the woodsman, standing from her chair nervously as she backs away from him.*

If the Party haven't pieced it together yet, have the barman push them to it.

> *The barman approaches the party in a hushed tone.*
>
> *"Do you think that the monster... Delvin did that to him?"*

If the Party already suspected the woodsman of being infected or being a wererat, and either want to kill him, suggest they stab his leg and watch it heal immediately before their eyes, then simply have him begin to turn. If they want to restrain him, let them do so by tying him to the chair with rope.

> *The woodsman is rapidly falling in and out of consciousness, making the task of moving / restraining him much easier.*

Belladonna Surprise

If you decided that Valiria stayed unconscious, and the Party do not have **belladonna** or **variscite**, move onto the 'Valiria is Unconscious' section under 'The worst possible outcome'.

If the Party doesn't remember the **belladonna** connection or that Valiria was harvesting it when she first saw the creature, have Valiria offer a sprig of it to the them, she is too scared to approach the woodsman herself.

> *"Here, try this! It's **belladonna** I picked this morning, this is the same plant I was gathering when I saw the monster last month." she says shakily, her eyes never leaving the woodsman, she offers the Party a bundle of **belladonna** (wrapped in cloth).*
>
> ***Ignore the check and poison damage** in this instance, unless she was knocked out earlier, in which case she doesn't warn the Party or wrap it in cloth as 'payback'.*

If the Party uses the **belladonna** on the woodsman, either by touching him with it or making him eat it, he takes **3d6 Poison damage** (and **3d6 Psychic damage** if they jam the **belladonna** into his wound, if the Character who does this is wearing **Greelas ring**, the woodsman **dies** but the reason is not revealed). This damage is only applied once, and **he immediately begins to turn into a wererat**.

If the Party simply approaches him with it:

> *You watch as the woodsman recoils in horror at the sight of the **belladonna**, he begins to beg, pleading that they get away from him.*
>
> *If they continue to approach him, but don't use it on him, the Party watch as his skin blisters, peels and falls to the floor in bloody chunks as he tries to escape from the plant, (his bonds breaking as he thrashes), stumbling backwards towards the wall, knocking over tables, drinks, and barrels as he claws at his flesh, his bones snapping as he contorts in front of everyone. His blood curdling screams terrifying the villagers, who begin to back into the opposite corner of the tavern.*

If the Party makes him eat the **belladonna** (and **variscite**) (only if he is restrained or approached him with it previously):

> ***Dexterity DC 12** – You stuff the **belladonna** (and **variscite**) into the woodsmans mouth and watch as his tongue blisters and eyes bulge, he screams and tries to spit it out but only manages to vomit.*
>
> *Bloody chunks slap to the ground as he begins to thrash wildly, his bonds breaking as he tumbles backwards onto the floor. He starts knocking over tables, drinks, and barrels as he claws at his flesh, his bones snapping as he contorts in front of everyone.*

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His blood curdling screams terrifying the villagers, who begin to back into the opposite corner of the tavern.

Should they fail this check, have them roll a ***Constitution DC 10*** *to see if they are infected but otherwise continue as above:*

Your finger is caught on his teeth as you stuff the Belladonna into his mouth, the skin rips and bleeds as you pull your hand away.

If the Party used both ***belladonna*** *and* ***variscite*** *at once:*

As he cowers to the corner you watch as his stomach begins to bulge and distend, the skin cracking in bloody streaks across his abdomen. His mouth flaps idly as the cracked skin seeps open, his enlarged stomach flopping out of the hole. He is dead.

If the Party presses it to his skin:

You watch as the ***belladonna*** *wilts as you drag it across his skin, leaving large bubbling welts wherever it touched. The welts burst open as he screams and he claws at his flesh trying to rip the essence of the* ***belladonna*** *away from his flesh. His bones snap as he begins to contort. (His bonds breaking as he thrashes), stumbling around towards the wall, knocking over tables, drinks, and barrels. His blood curdling screams terrifying the villagers, who begin to back into the opposite corner of the tavern.*

If the Character that presses the **belladonna** into the wound is wearing **Greelas ring**:

You watch as your hand melts into the woodsmans wound, the ***belladonna*** *seemingly bubbling in your palm and wilting as he roars in pain, his eyes bulging, the veins popping.*

His body begins to spasm, (his bonds breaking as he thrashes), stumbling around towards the wall, knocking over tables, drinks, and barrels. You see bones snapping through the muscles at odd angles, welts and rashes spreading rapidly across his body. His flesh begins to rupture, muscle showing through the cracked flesh, his blood is bubbling out of the seams. Nearly as quickly as it begins, it ends, the woodsmans body goes limp and slumps, he is dead.

Have the character roll a ***Constitution DC 15*** *check to see if they are infected.*

Your hand is cut by a protruding and jagged piece of bone, it appears to be superficial.

If the Party decides to simply touch him with the **variscite** and do nothing else :

You press the gem to the woodsmans skin, nothing seems to happen.

You press the gem into the woodsmans wounds, pierce him with it, or make him swallow it (make them roll the same check for being infected with **Lycanthropy** as if they were feeding him **belladonna**):

A high pitched shriek escapes him and you watch the veins around the gem turn dark green. He stumbles backwards towards the wall, knocking over tables, drinks, and barrels as he claws at his flesh, his bones snapping as he contorts in front of everyone.

His blood curdling screams terrifying the villagers, who begin to back into the opposite corner of the tavern.

Lycanthropes infected with variscite gain Disadvantage to damage rolls from all sources.

Whatever happens above, the commotion and screams of the villagers and the woodsman, echo out into the night.

Delvin Returns

The shouts and roars draw Delvin to the tavern.

A piercing shriek rips through the air, another monster lurks somewhere outside.



Self-Portrait with Magic Scene by Pieter van Laer

If the Woodsman is Alive

If the Party used the Belladonna on him earlier:

The woodsman is already terrified of the Belladonna, but when it hears another wererat shriek it panics, it starts to claw at the window, smashing it and fleeing to the woods.

The villagers start huddling together, staring intently at the window, in the distance they see the

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shadowy blur of him being tackled by the other creature and sharp shrieks cutting off abruptly, followed by a gurgling roar.



Characters with Darkvision can see it more clearly; the attacking creature easily takes the woodsman down, his neck snapping as he is pulled to the ground, you watch as he begins to feast on the woodsmans corpse, then the vomiting begins, they watch as he scratches at his face, the fluid pouring between his paws as he shrieks.

Delvin is now weakened by the Belladonna that the woodsman had in his system (he takes the full **Poison and Psychic damage** listed in the previous section). The villagers are now fully intent on fleeing the village.

"We need to run! Get out of here while we still can!" says Valiria, the villagers begin to rush out of the tavern.

Another shriek pierces the chaos, and you see the shadow pounding towards the tavern through the window.

If the Party did not poison him with the Belladonna:

The woodsman shrieks in reply to the monster, taunting it and challenging it. Delvin bursts through a window, as the two wererats square off and circle each other the villagers begin to rush out the door.

Move on to the 'Flee the Village' section.

If the Woodsman is Dead

If the Party killed the woodsman:

The screams from outside grows closer, the sound of windows being broken and the shutters being hammered around the tavern fills the air. The window above the woodsmans body shatters, the shutters splintering off their hinges as the wererat smashes into the tavern.

If the Party used Belladonna to kill the woodsman:

As the last of the villagers flee, the Party and the barman watch as this other monster begins to sniff and snarl in disgust at the woodsman corpse.

Move on to the 'Flee the Village' section.

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Flee the Village

At this point the tavern is wrecked, either Delvin or the woodsman, have trashed the tables, chairs, drinks, and have smashed open the barrels of ale.

It should come as no surprise but if the Party have got to this point without having access to anything that will sufficiently damage the wererat and things have been going poorly for them they should be discouraged from fighting.

You could possibly describe something along the lines of they watch as a lantern smashes and starts a fire that damages a wererat if they are intent on doing some damage, or you could even choose to have Valiria give the rest of her **belladonna** to them at this point if you think they will stay to fight.

> *"Here, this is the last of it!" Valiria says as she hurriedly pushes the **belladonna** into the Characters hands and flees through the door.*

If the Party kill a wererat (Unless you want it to, this specifically does not include killing the woodsman with the combination of **belladonna** and **variscite** or a weakened Delvin) without you being lenient with the encounter and rules, you may choose to grant them an additional level due to its difficulty, possibly bringing them up to level 3 at the end of the session.

If the woodsman is dead

Delvin ate his corpse

As Delvin ate the poisoned corpse of the woodsman, he is weakened (using the same rolls for both **Poison and Psychic damage** as you rolled for the woodsman). Depending on how poorly the damage roll goes for him he will be significantly weakened, possibly being a one hit kill.

> *The Party watches as Delvin snarls and sways, clearly in a tremendous amount of pain after devouring the poisoned corpse of the woodsman.*

At this point, the Party may stand a chance in finishing him off, but if they are having trouble move to the 'Amphail Ale Ablaze' section. Otherwise, move onto the 'What Next?' section.

The Party killed the woodsman

Unless the Party fully understand the use of Belladonna, and to a lesser extent the Variscite, they will likely not be able to kill Delvin.

> *Delvin seems to examine the woodsmans corpse, sniffing and grimacing as it examines the wounds and body.*
>
> *He turns to the Party, baring his teeth.*

If they decide to fight him and are having trouble move to the 'Amphail Ale Ablaze' section. Otherwise, move onto the 'What Next?' section.

If the woodsman is alive

While there may be the possibility that the Party could kill one wererat using any of the tools they have managed to gather, it is a very different task fighting both.

The only defence the party will have is the **belladonna** if Valiria gave it to them, and at a certain point the wererats will not be deterred by it and begin attacking the Party.

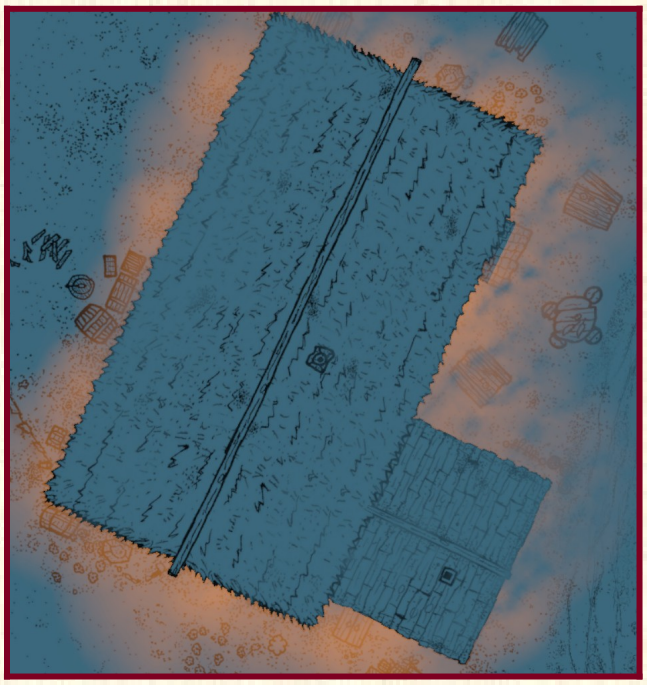
The wererats will be preoccupied with each other and begin fighting, the Party should use this as their chance to flee. If they don't take the hint:

> *As the wererats begin to fight, their claws and teeth taking chunks of flesh out of each other the Party see that they aren't damaging each other with their attacks, as soon as a chunk of flesh or gaping wound is created, it is healed, its a fight of stamina and the loser will be whoever flees first.*

If they decide to fight them move immediately to the 'Amphail Ale Ablaze' section.

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Amphail Ale Ablaze



Assuming the Party haven't thought to use the **moonshine**:

> *"Quickly! Run!" the barman shouts, motioning the Party to the door, they watch as he smashes open his barrel of homemade moonshine, picking it up and pouring it all over the ground before throwing the empty container at Delvin, which draws the monsters attention.*

If for whatever god forsaken reason they do not flee when the fire starts:

> *The fire spreads rapidly forcing the Party towards the door.*
>
> *Throw a **1d6 fire damage** per round onto anyone that still isn't getting the hint.*

The barman saves the day

> *As the monster turns towards the barman, he smashes an oil lantern onto the ground, igniting the moonshine.*
>
> *The Party watch as the barman, Delvin, and most of the tavern erupts in flames in front of them.*
>
> *If Delvin was relatively unharmed in the fight with the Party, he flees out of the window he came in, still on fire and off into the woods. Otherwise, the Party watch as he collapses into the barman, a final billowing of flame surrounding the pair.*

The barman obviously dies as a result of this, locking the Party out of the highest reward.

The Party should flee at this point, moving onto the 'What Next?' section.

The Party saves the day

The Party could either remember about the **moonshine** beforehand and use it themselves, in which case the barman will flee, or ignite it themselves before the barman, in which case he will not be in the path of the flames.

Give them **advantage on Dexterity** saves to avoid the resulting flames while they flee, if they instead decide to fight in a rapidly burning building, have Delvin flee.

> *As the intensity of the flames rises, Delvin flees out of the window he came in, shrieking as embers fall from his burnt flesh as he runs to the woods.*

Ideally, the barman does not die, either by the Party redrawing Delvins attention or they manage to ignite the moonshine before the barman does it and he flees. In any case, move onto the 'What Next?' section.

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The Worst Possible Outcome

So your Party decided to be cowards or heroes? You can offer multiple chances for your Party to return to the villagers throughout this section, but should they maliciously ignore these, this section will almost certainly kill every Character and most if not all of the villagers.



The Blessed Guillaume de Toulouse Tormented by Demons by Ambroise Frédeau

The Wererats the party will be fighting have Advantage against all attacks made with non-Silvered weapons with the exception of magical attacks, the Party almost certainly will not have Silvered or Magical weapons, nor will they have discovered the weaknesses of the Lycanthropes.

Additionally, every bite that the Party receives enacts a **Constitution DC 10** saving throw, else they also are cursed with lycanthropy. Should the Party acquire the disease through blood, perhaps by swallowing the blood from a lycanthropes wound, the roll becomes a **DC 15**.

Should the Party insist on fighting any of the wererats, have the character with the highest Intelligence realise what they are.

> *The Character is able to to recall information about creatures such as these, it appears to be some sort of lycanthrope, probably a wererat. They are incredibly dangerous as they have Advantage against all but silvered or magical attacks.*

The villagers will be split between two groups, those that stay in the tavern, and those that choose to flee. Valiria will choose to stay in the tavern by default.

The Party fights Delvin when first encountering him

The story assumes Greela is dead, so you will likely need to improvise some aspects of the remaining plot, references to Greela can be substituted with a random villager.

They try to save Greela

You will need to track the actions of 7 villagers, they will become Terrified if anyone dies, and 1 wererat who will likely be closest to Greela, so you may be able to still kill him.

A fight begins as the Party interfere.

> *The creature snarls as you try to stop Greela, it's eyes lock hungrily onto him.*

You could have Delvin flee at any point, in such a case move onto 'After Greela Dies' section below if the Party are intent on chasing after him.

After Greela dies

So the Party watched that happen and decided to chase after the monster? Heroic, dumb but heroic.

> *The villagers begin to panic and flee as Greela is eviscerated in front of them, then turn to blind terror as Elimars pitchfork does nothing to the creature, the Party watches them sprint back to the tavern before chasing after the monster.*
>
> *You rush after the monster, following a slowly fading blood trail and tracks into the woods.*
>
> ***Wisdom (Survival) DC 15** – You manage to follow the dwindling trail into the woods, the trail seems to simply stop in a clearing, there are old fallen trees in the middle of the area.*

Allow an automatic success on an ability check to make the Party realise that the creature must have healed from its wounds already, if they decide to turn back at this point, loop back to the 'The Woodsman Turns' section and run it as normal, or perhaps force them to by saying they were unable to find the creature.

If they still decide to chase after it then combat begins,

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they are **Surprised** when Delvin drops from a tree in the middle of the Party, unless:

> ***Wisdom (Survival) DC 18*** *– You spot Delvin a nearby tree, crouched and ready to pounce, you are not Surprised when the attack begins.*

If they survive this encounter, either through you deciding that Delvin disengages once he has taken enough damage or they somehow manage to kill him, maybe he even gets knocked into a bush of **belladonna** and flees, either return them to 'The woodsman turns' section or move onto the 'Massacre' section below.

Tavern villagers

Quick return

This assumes the Party left the group of villagers outside but returned before the woodsman turned into a wererat, this happens if the party spends too much time outside, you could looting multiple houses and/or spending too much time investigating or chasing Delvin but not fighting him, after the villagers flee to the tavern after Greela dies.

5 Villagers will have already left the tavern at this point, heading South, it's up to you if they died or can be found in the 'What Next?' section, if they died the Party will be locked out of the highest reward.

> *The Party hears screams of panic coming from the tavern, as they draw near they realise that the villagers have barricaded the doors and windows thinking that the Party perished outside.*

The Party may now try to enter the tavern, have them roll a **Strength DC 12** ability check to break through the door, or have them attack it to break it down, or maybe the barman unblock the door.

You could allow them Advantage or to automatically succeed in an ability check to smash through the door, this will loop everything back to 'The Woodsman Turns' section, where he is just beginning to turn. Otherwise move to the 'Massacre' section below.

Massacre

Quick return

Should the Party refuse to enter the tavern, or you are feeling particularly cruel, the villagers have effectively trapped themselves in with the woodsman who will turn into a wererat and disembowel everyone inside before smashing through the barricade onto the street.

All 18 villagers will now be dead, locking the Party out of rewards unless they spend time looting.

> *As the screams reach a fever pitch, tables breaking and glasses smashing can be heard, then blood-curdling screams and wet, thick snaps of bones.*
>
> 
>
> *Study of Feet and Hands by Théodore Géricault*
>
> *The screams stop and the door to the tavern explodes into shards as the monster crashes onto the street.*

The woodsman will fight the Party if they did not flee before it escaped the tavern and the commotion will have drawn Delvin back to the village, the woodsman will be weakened by **belladonna** poisoning though, having devoured Valeria and her stash of **belladonna** accidentally

If you are feeling lenient, perhaps the two wererats fight each other, maybe Delvin sees the corpse of Valiria and this causes him to turn on the woodsman, which would give the Party another opportunity to flee. The Party should be encouraged to flee, as noted in the previous section, they will certainly have no effective way to damage either wererat and while Delvin may attack the woodsman, he will also attack the Party if they get involved.

Or you can have the two wererats will attack the Party as allies.

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The Party dealt with Delvin

If you are feeling lenient, perhaps allow the Party to automatically succeed on an ability check to discover that there is another wererat inside, devouring the dead villagers, which will give them an opportunity to flee, if they do so, move onto the 'What Next?' section. **All 18 villagers are dead, locking the Party out of rewards unless they spend time looting.**

> *The Party heads back to the village, it is silent. As they draw closer to the tavern they discover that the villagers had indeed barricaded the building but the only sound coming from beyond the barricade is wet, sloppy guzzling.*

If they decide to enter the tavern, have them roll a **Strength DC 12** ability check to break through the door, or have them attack it to break it down. Combat will begin immediately with the woodsman who may even break through the door himself which would leave the party **Surprised** as they also would likely not know that this is the woodsman and there was another wererat.

You can allow the same sort of concessions as with the fight with Delvin if you are feeling lenient, or have the commotion draw a now fully healed Delvin back, leaving the Party to fight two wererats.

If they manage to survive this, move onto the 'What Next?' section.

The Party leave

This assumes the Party are leaving before resolving the session as intended.

They go North

If any wererats are alive, use them to drive the Party back as there is nothing prepared in the campaign for travelling away from Waterdeep. If they are intent, they will reach Red Larch in four days.

They go East

If any wererats are alive, use them to drive the Party back as there is nothing prepared in the campaign for travelling away from Waterdeep. If they are intent, they will reach Bargewright Inn in three days.

They go South

Have them encounter any villagers if any were able to flee, maybe they are convinced to go back for a reward, otherwise just move onto the 'What Next?' section, where there will almost definitely time for the goblin ambush section, and depending on what point they left, you could even consider not awarding them a level up.

Valiria is unconscious

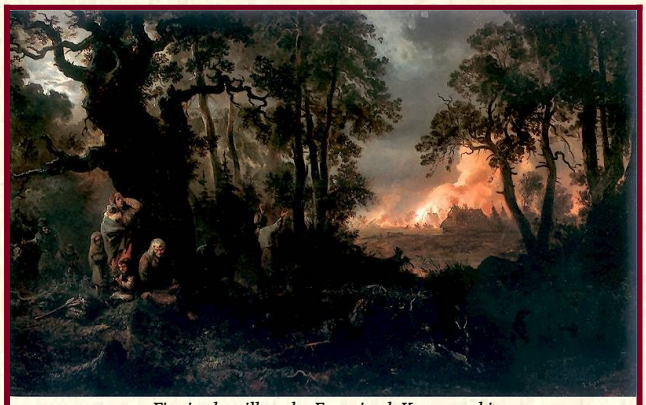
This will be a very large combat encounter, starting with the woodsman turning into a wererat and culminating in Delvin joining the fray, you will need to personally track the actions of 18 NPCs.

The entirety of the town will be in the tavern, with Valiria being **Unconscious**, assuming no-one other than Greela is missing and/or dead. 16 villagers in total, they are all considered fully **Frightened** unless the Party previously rallied them.

At some point during the fight, Delvin will smash through the window and join the fight, the point at which he enters and who he attacks is up to you, you may decide he becomes preoccupied with the woodsman at which point you could loop back to the 'Amphail Ale Ablaze' section and have any remaining villagers escape.

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What Next?



Fire in the village by Franciszek Kostrzewski

If both wererats are dead, there is technically nothing stopping the Party from looting the town, you could have some villagers return or disapprove of their actions, but otherwise see the Loot section, there isn't anything of particular note except within Greelas home if they did not already loot it. You could have any surviving wererats return if they decide to loot, still damaged if they were poisoned by the **belladonna** or **variscite**, but otherwise fully healed.

If time is an issue, the session can end at this point explaining that the Party is now on the way to a Waterdeep]to explain what happened in Amphail to the Lords of Waterdeep.

> *The Party escorts the villagers South along the Long Road to Waterdeep, a harrowing three day journey awaits them*

If the Party wants to continue you can say that they are asked to escort survivors on the three day long journey, or they can ignore the survivors and travel there themselves, the survivors catch up to the party anyway if they camp near the Long Road, possibly triggering a goblin ambush.

> *"We must go to Waterdeep and tell the Lords what happened here!" Valiria (or anyone else if she is dead) pleads to the Party.*

If the Party is at this point because the villagers are dead, you may even consider having the wererats follow them, or report back to their master making them aware of the Party much earlier than they would have been otherwise.

> *The Party flees South along the Long Road towards Waterdeep, a three day journey away.*

If any of the Party dropped to 0 HP and you are feeling lenient have their stabilised body brought by the fleeing villagers, they could at this point also roll new characters and insert them in place of any of the villagers that survived.

Goblin Ambush

The villagers all have 1 level of **Exhaustion**.

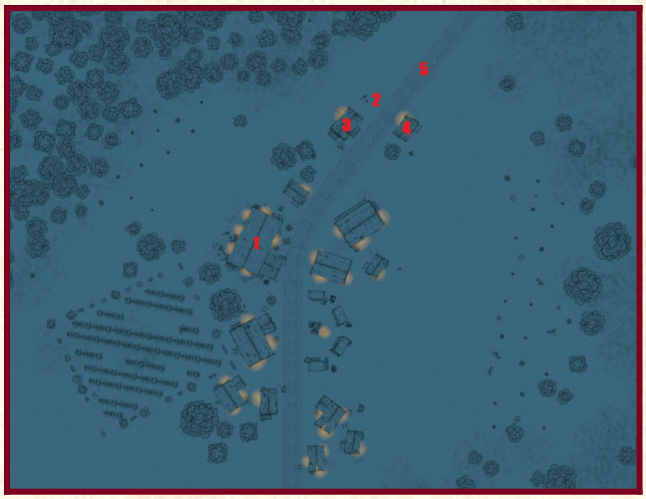
This is a much more standard, classic DnD fight between the Party & friends and a few goblins, intended to be a fun ending to the session or a chance for the Party to try out normal combat for the first time in an otherwise roleplay heavy session. This should probably be skipped if the Party is heavily hurt, or you could have it happen after a Long Rest where they are refreshed, you could even go through levelling up beforehand if there is time in your session and they are interested as this would increase the rewards they get.

The goblins will tend to favour attacking the villagers as they are unarmed and unarmoured, having only large sticks (clubs) to defend themselves.

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Other Information

Town Map



1. The Amphail Ale
2. The location of Delvins 'body'
3. Greelas house
4. Valirias house
5. Where the party first see the wererat

Reward

The Party will level up at the end of this session, in addition the villagers will reward the Party using the following table, bear in mind these people are simple villagers and are poor, on top of having to hurriedly flee their town.

If Valiria has died the vials of Belladonna Analgesic will not be rewarded at all.

These amounts are meant to reflect an amount that the villagers would have in their pockets to offer the Party for saving them, if they were pick-pocketed at any point or just didn't do anything heroic, reduce the reward.

Villagers remaining	Reward
16 (Delvin, Greela, and the woodsman are the only ones missing / dead)	- 10 / 20 / 40 sp per Character (1st / 2nd / 3rd level). - Elimars ring, identical to Greelas. - A vial of Belladonna Analgesic per Character. - A set of engraved bone dice (worth 25 gp).
10 – 15	- 8 / 16 / 32 sp per Character (1st / 2nd / 3rd level). - Elimars ring, identical to Greelas (if alive). - A vial of Belladonna Analgesic per Character (if alive). - A set of engraved bone dice (worth 25 gp).
5 – 9	- 6 / 12 / 26 sp per Character (1st / 2nd / 3rd level). - Elimars ring, identical to Greelas (if alive). - A vial of Belladonna Analgesic per Character (if alive).
1 – 4	- 4 / 8 / 16 sp per Character (1st / 2nd / 3rd level). - Elimars ring, identical to Greelas (if alive). - A vial of Belladonna Analgesic per Character (if alive).
0	The Party only leaves with whatever they were able to loot or steal.

Homebrew rules

Belladonna

If a victim bitten by a lycanthrope ate a sprig of belladonna within an hour of the bite, they have a chance of not contracting the disease. The belladonna, however, has to be relatively fresh, not picked any later than a week ago. Though consumption of belladonna works equally as well for giants and giant-kin infected with lycanthropy, they needed to consume much larger amounts than the smaller humanoid races.

Characters **proficient in Nature** will know that belladonna is poisonous and if they know it is used as a cure, that there is only a **25% chance that lycanthropy will be cured per sprig ingested**.

When touching belladonna, a Character whose skin touches the plant must make an **Intelligence (Nature)**

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check of DC 10 or higher, otherwise take **1d2 poison damage.**

To administer belladonna without negative consequences a Character must make an **Intelligence (Nature) ability check of DC 10 or higher** using a **Herbalism Kit** to effectively extract the beneficial elements of the plant. Treatment this way increases the cure chance by 25%.

Characters **proficient with a Herbalism Kit** will know that they can increase this cure chance by increasing the number of sprigs involved. Should the Character decide to administer multiple sprigs to increase the cure chance, modify the **DC** check as follows:

- 1 additional sprig – **DC 15**, increases cure chance by 50% (75% total).
- 2 additional sprigs – **DC 20**, increases cure chance by 75% (100% total).

Should the character fail these checks, the base bonus of 25% is still in effect (50%) but the Character ingesting the mixture must make a saving throw in line with raw ingestion of multiple sprigs detailed below.

To successfully ingest the plant, a character must make a **Constitution saving throw of DC 15 or higher**, otherwise they will take **2d6 poison damage** and be **Poisoned**, they will also gain 1 level of **Exhaustion**.

Should any Character ingest belladonna multiple times before the initial effects have worn off, they must make a **Constitution saving throw of DC 20 or higher,** otherwise they will take **2d6 poison damage** as well as receive a **penalty of -1 to Constitution (to a minimum of 1) for 48 hours.** This effect stacks with each additional ingestion and additional effects are described below:

- 2 – **Visually Impaired**, the Character is unable to see further than 5ft clearly for 48 hours. **They gain Disadvantage on any action or roll taking place further than that.**
- 3 – The Character experiences terrifying hallucinations, randomly attacking the closest target. They gain 1 level of **Exhaustion**.
- 4 – The Character receives a **penalty of -1 to Dexterity (to a minimum of 1) for 48 hours**. They gain 1 level of **Exhaustion**.
- 5 – The Character receives a **penalty of -1 to Strength (to a minimum of 1) for 48 hours.** They gain 1 level of **Exhaustion**.
- 6 -**Paralysed**, the Character **automatically fails Strength and Dexterity saving throws. Attack rolls against the character have advantage and any attack that hits the character is a critical hit if the attacker is within 5 feet of the character. The effect lasts 24 hours.** They gain 1 level of **Exhaustion.**

These effects can be removed with the use of **Belladonna Antitoxin** or spells that specifically **remove poison**, however the levels of **Exhaustion** stay.

Exhaustion – Characters **proficient with herbalism kits** and **Nature** can make an **Intelligence (Nature) DC 12** check to extract a poison from nightshade that can be applied to piercing and slashing weapons.

A creature injured by a weapon coated in this poison must make a **DC 14 Constitution** saving throw, taking **3d6 poison damage** on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. If the saving throw failed by 5 or more, the poisoned creature also takes **3d6 psychic damage**.

Lycanthropes have disadvantage to the saving throws.

Analgesic – Characters **proficient with Alchemy Supplies** and **Arcana** can make an **Intelligence (Arcana) DC 14** check to craft a numbing salve from this plant. Characters that use a dose of this salve gain 3d4 temporary hit points, which fade after 1 hour.

Variscite

Variscite is poisonous to lycanthropes and, if delivered into the bloodstream on the tip of a weapon, caused triple the normal damage for that strike. Once a lycanthrope was infected with variscite, further exposure did no additional harm until the subject recovered—a process that took a full 24 hours.

Infection could also be accomplished if a variscite stone, say mounted in a ring or other jewellery, were pressed into an open wound on a lycanthrope, or touched to the creature's tongue.

Lycanthropes infected with variscite gain Disadvantage to damage rolls from all sources.

Lycanthropy

Lycanthropy brought with it a tremendous resilience to most forms of damage, that was generally seen and known to be overcome only by magic and silvered weaponry. However this was just a rumour that the owner of a silver mine was more than happy to spread spread.

*Lycanthropes gain **Advantage on damage rolls for all non-silvered and non-magical attacks, but***

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Disadvantage on damage rolls for attacks made with Silvered weapons.

However, they could also be injured and poisoned by the gemstone variscite and the plant belladonna.

Transmission through a bite carries a **Constitution DC10** saving throw, through saliva or bodily fluids, or a **DC15 through blood**.

Should a lycanthrope hold their bite for long enough, or the target submits willingly, there is no saving throw to prevent transmission.

Lycanthropes have the ability to Regenerate their wounds, which scales with their type and age, with freshly infected lycanthropes not having the ability at all, this effect does not occur if they were damaged by Silvered weapons, attacks made with Belladonna Poison, or if the attack makes use of Variscite.

True lycanthropes are immune from Variscite poisoning but still take the triple damage penalty.

True lycanthropes are not subject to the disadvantage to Belladonna saving throws.

As freshly turned wererats, the woodsman and Delvin only possess trivial **health regeneration at 5HP per round.**

Spells that remove curses would cure the effected individual of lycanthropy, only if cast on the night before a full moon, before their first natural transformation, and the target is not a True Lycanthrope.

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